

WEDDING PLANNING MASTER BUNDLE

The Complete System for Planning Your Perfect Day

Budget Tracker | Timeline | Vendor Management | Guest Lists

By Daniel Tesfamariam

Everything you need to plan a beautiful wedding
without the stress, overwhelm, or overspending.

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CHAPTER 1: GETTING STARTED

Congratulations on Your Engagement!

Planning a wedding is one of the most exciting and complex projects you will ever undertake. This planner is designed to break down the entire process into manageable steps so you can enjoy the journey without feeling overwhelmed.

Whether you are planning an intimate ceremony for 30 guests or a grand celebration for 300, this system adapts to your needs. The key to stress-free wedding planning is organization, communication, and starting early.

Wedding Vision Worksheet

Before diving into logistics, take time to clarify your shared vision:

Our wedding date (or target month): _____

Engagement date: _____

Planning timeline (months until wedding): _____

Our overall budget range: \$_____ to \$_____

Who is contributing financially?

Couple: \$_____

Partner 1 family: \$_____

Partner 2 family: \$_____

Other: \$_____

TOTAL BUDGET: \$_____

Estimated guest count: _____

Wedding style (circle): Formal | Semi-Formal | Casual | Rustic | Modern | Vintage

Indoor or Outdoor preference: _____

Color palette ideas: _____

Season preference: _____

Religious or cultural traditions to include: _____

Our Non-Negotiables

Things that are MOST important to us (top 5):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Things we are willing to skip or simplify:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Wedding Party

Maid/Matron of Honor: _____

Best Man: _____

Bridesmaid 1: _____

Bridesmaid 2: _____

Bridesmaid 3: _____

Bridesmaid 4: _____

Groomsman 1: _____

Groomsman 2: _____

Groomsman 3: _____

Groomsman 4: _____

Flower Girl: _____

Ring Bearer: _____

Officiant: _____

Readers/Speakers: _____

Key Contacts & Passwords

Wedding Planner/Coordinator: _____ Phone: _____

Venue Contact: _____ Phone: _____

Caterer: _____ Phone: _____

Photographer: _____ Phone: _____

DJ/Band: _____ Phone: _____

Florist: _____ Phone: _____

Baker: _____ Phone: _____

Wedding website login: _____

Registry login: _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 1

-
- [] Complete the wedding vision worksheet together
 - [] Agree on total budget and who contributes what
 - [] Create initial guest list draft (names only)
 - [] Choose your wedding party members
 - [] Set up a shared planning folder (Google Drive or similar)
 - [] Begin researching venues in your area and price range

CHAPTER 2: BUDGET MASTER TRACKER

Budget Planning Philosophy

The average wedding costs between \$20,000 and \$35,000, but yours can be whatever fits your financial reality. The key is not how much you spend but how intentionally you allocate your resources toward the things that matter most to you as a couple.

This budget tracker helps you set realistic allocations, track every expense as it occurs, and avoid the surprise overages that cause wedding planning stress.

Recommended Budget Allocation Percentages

- Venue & Catering: 40-50% of total budget
- Photography & Videography: 10-12%
- Music & Entertainment: 8-10%
- Flowers & Decor: 8-10%
- Attire & Beauty: 8-10%
- Stationery & Invitations: 2-3%
- Transportation: 2-3%
- Wedding Rings: 2-3%
- Gifts & Favors: 2-3%
- Contingency Fund: 5-10% (this is essential!)

MASTER BUDGET OVERVIEW

Total Wedding Budget: \$_____

CATEGORY: VENUE & RECEPTION

Budget Allocated: \$_____ | Actual Spent: \$_____ | Difference: \$_____

Ceremony venue rental

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Reception venue rental

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Site coordinator fee

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Tables and chairs rental

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Linens and tableware

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Lighting upgrades

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Sound system rental

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Parking and valet

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Restroom rentals (outdoor)

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Venue insurance

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Security/crowd management

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Setup and teardown fees

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

SUBTOTAL - VENUE & RECEPTION: Estimated \$_____ | Actual \$_____

CATEGORY: CATERING & BAR

Budget Allocated: \$_____ | Actual Spent: \$_____ | Difference: \$_____

Per-person dinner cost

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Cocktail hour appetizers

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Late night snack station

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Wedding cake or desserts

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Groom cake

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Dessert table extras

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Bar service (open bar)

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Specialty cocktails

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Non-alcoholic beverages

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Service charge and gratuity

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

China and flatware upgrade

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Dietary accommodation meals

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

SUBTOTAL - CATERING & BAR: Estimated \$_____ | Actual \$_____

CATEGORY: PHOTOGRAPHY & VIDEO

Budget Allocated: \$_____ | Actual Spent: \$_____ | Difference: \$_____

Lead photographer (8 hrs)

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Second photographer

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Engagement session

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Bridal portrait session

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Photo album

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Digital files and rights

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Videographer (8 hrs)

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Highlight reel editing

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Full ceremony video

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Drone footage

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Photo booth rental

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Extra hours coverage

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

SUBTOTAL - PHOTOGRAPHY & VIDEO: Estimated \$_____ | Actual \$_____

CATEGORY: MUSIC & ENTERTAINMENT

Budget Allocated: \$_____ | Actual Spent: \$_____ | Difference: \$_____

Ceremony musicians

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Cocktail hour music

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

DJ for reception

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Live band

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Sound equipment rental

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

MC/emcee

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Special performances

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Dance floor rental

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Lighting design

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Sparklers or confetti

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

SUBTOTAL - MUSIC & ENTERTAINMENT: Estimated \$_____ | Actual \$_____

CATEGORY: FLOWERS & DECOR

Budget Allocated: \$_____ | Actual Spent: \$_____ | Difference: \$_____

Bridal bouquet

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Bridesmaid bouquets (x4)

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Boutonni res (x6)

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Corsages (x4)

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Ceremony arch/backdrop

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Ceremony aisle decor

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Reception centerpieces

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Head table arrangements

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Cake flowers

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Flower girl petals

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Cocktail hour flowers

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Restroom arrangements

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Toss bouquet

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Delivery and setup fee

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

SUBTOTAL - FLOWERS & DECOR: Estimated \$_____ | Actual \$_____

CATEGORY: ATTIRE & BEAUTY

Budget Allocated: \$_____ | Actual Spent: \$_____ | Difference: \$_____

Wedding dress/suit

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Alterations

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Veil or headpiece

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Wedding shoes

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Jewelry

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Undergarments

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Groom suit/tux

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Groom shoes

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Groom accessories

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Hair styling

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Makeup artist

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Trial hair and makeup

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Bridesmaids hair

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Bridesmaids makeup

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Getting ready robes

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

SUBTOTAL - ATTIRE & BEAUTY: Estimated \$_____ | Actual \$_____

CATEGORY: STATIONERY

Budget Allocated: \$_____ | Actual Spent: \$_____ | Difference: \$_____

Save the dates

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Invitations suite

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

RSVP cards and postage

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Programs

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Menu cards

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Place cards

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Table numbers

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Thank you cards

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Signage (welcome, seating)

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Postage for all mailings

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Calligraphy services

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

SUBTOTAL - STATIONERY: Estimated \$_____ | Actual \$_____

CATEGORY: EXTRAS & GIFTS

Budget Allocated: \$_____ | Actual Spent: \$_____ | Difference: \$_____

Wedding party gifts

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Parent gifts

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Welcome bags

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Guest favors

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Tips for vendors

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Marriage license fee

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Officiant fee

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Hotel room (wedding night)

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Transportation (limo/bus)

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Wedding rings

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

Ring insurance

Estimated: \$_____ | Actual: \$_____ | Vendor: _____ | Paid? []

SUBTOTAL - EXTRAS & GIFTS: Estimated \$_____ | Actual \$_____

MONTHLY PAYMENT TRACKER

January

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Monthly Total: \$ _____

February

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Monthly Total: \$ _____

March

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Monthly Total: \$ _____

April

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Monthly Total: \$ _____

May

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Monthly Total: \$ _____

June

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid

Monthly Total: \$ _____

July

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Monthly Total: \$ _____

August

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Monthly Total: \$ _____

September

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Monthly Total: \$ _____

October

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Monthly Total: \$ _____

November

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Monthly Total: \$ _____

December

Payment 1: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 2: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 3: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Payment 4: \$ _____ To: _____ Date: _____ ☐ Paid
Monthly Total: \$ _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 2

- ☐ Set your total budget and allocate percentages per category
- ☐ Fill in estimated costs for all categories
- ☐ Set up a dedicated wedding bank account or credit card
- ☐ Track every payment in the monthly tracker
- ☐ Review budget vs actuals weekly
- ☐ Keep all receipts and contracts in one folder

CHAPTER 3: 12-MONTH WEDDING TIMELINE

This comprehensive month-by-month timeline ensures nothing falls through the cracks.
Adjust timing based on your specific wedding date and planning duration.

12 MONTHS BEFORE

- ☐ Set overall budget and discuss financial contributions
- ☐ Create initial guest list (determine approximate headcount)
- ☐ Research and tour potential venues (book early - venues fill up fast)
- ☐ Decide on wedding date (have 2-3 backup dates)
- ☐ Book ceremony and reception venues
- ☐ Begin researching photographers (they book 12+ months out)
- ☐ Start thinking about wedding party selections
- ☐ Consider hiring a wedding planner or day-of coordinator
- ☐ Set up wedding email address for all vendor communications
- ☐ Create shared planning document or spreadsheet
- ☐ Discuss general style and theme preferences
- ☐ Start a wedding inspiration board (Pinterest or physical)

Notes: _____

11 MONTHS BEFORE

- ☐ Book photographer and videographer
- ☐ Research and book caterer (if not included with venue)
- ☐ Book officiant
- ☐ Finalize wedding party - ask bridesmaids and groomsmen
- ☐ Start dress shopping (gowns take 4-6 months to arrive)
- ☐ Research florists and gather inspiration images
- ☐ Begin researching DJs or bands
- ☐ Set up wedding website
- ☐ Consider engagement photos (use for save the dates)
- ☐ Research wedding insurance options
- ☐ Start thinking about rehearsal dinner plans
- ☐ Create detailed timeline for planning milestones

Notes: _____

10 MONTHS BEFORE

- ☐ Book florist and discuss seasonal flower options
- ☐ Book DJ or band for reception
- ☐ Order wedding dress (allow 6 months for delivery)
- ☐ Book hotel room blocks for out-of-town guests
- ☐ Research invitation designers or DIY options
- ☐ Schedule engagement photoshoot
- ☐ Start planning honeymoon (book flights and hotels)
- ☐ Register for gifts at 2-3 stores
- ☐ Research hair and makeup artists
- ☐ Begin planning ceremony structure and readings
- ☐ Discuss transportation needs (guest shuttles, limo)

Notes: _____

9 MONTHS BEFORE

- ☐ Send save the dates (mail or digital)
- ☐ Book hair and makeup artist (schedule trial)
- ☐ Order bridesmaid dresses (allow 4 months for delivery)
- ☐ Groom begins shopping for suit or tux
- ☐ Finalize ceremony details (readings, music, vows)
- ☐ Book rehearsal dinner venue
- ☐ Research and book wedding cake baker
- ☐ Plan welcome bags for out-of-town guests
- ☐ Confirm honeymoon reservations
- ☐ Start working on wedding vows if writing your own
- ☐ Research rental companies (tables, chairs, decor)

Notes: _____

8 MONTHS BEFORE

- [] Finalize guest list (this drives many other decisions)
- [] Order invitations and envelopes
- [] Book rentals (furniture, linens, decor items)
- [] Plan and book bachelor/bachelorette parties
- [] Schedule cake tasting appointments
- [] Book transportation (limos, shuttles, vintage car)
- [] Begin planning reception layout and floor plan
- [] Order groomsmen suits or tuxes
- [] Research and book photo booth if desired
- [] Start compiling music playlists and must-play songs

Notes: _____

6 MONTHS BEFORE

- ☐ Attend cake tasting and finalize design
- ☐ Hair and makeup trial run
- ☐ Finalize menu selections with caterer
- ☐ Order wedding favors
- ☐ Plan ceremony music selections
- ☐ Finalize flower selections and arrangements
- ☐ Purchase wedding party gifts
- ☐ Book calligrapher for invitations if using one
- ☐ Address and stuff invitation envelopes
- ☐ Confirm all vendor contracts and payment schedules
- ☐ Purchase wedding day accessories (veil, shoes, jewelry)
- ☐ Plan seating chart strategy

Notes: _____

4 MONTHS BEFORE

- ☐ Mail invitations (allow 6-8 weeks before RSVP deadline)
- ☐ Apply for marriage license (check local requirements)
- ☐ Schedule dress fittings and alterations
- ☐ Finalize ceremony structure with officiant
- ☐ Write personal vows (if applicable)
- ☐ Plan and confirm rehearsal dinner details
- ☐ Order wedding programs
- ☐ Create day-of emergency kit
- ☐ Purchase gifts for parents
- ☐ Finalize playlist with DJ (must-play and do-not-play lists)
- ☐ Confirm honeymoon details and documents (passport check)

Notes: _____

2 MONTHS BEFORE

- ☐ Follow up with guests who have not RSVPed
- ☐ Finalize seating chart
- ☐ Give caterer final headcount
- ☐ Final dress fitting
- ☐ Break in wedding shoes at home
- ☐ Create detailed day-of timeline for wedding party
- ☐ Confirm all vendor arrival times and setup needs
- ☐ Write thank you notes for early gifts
- ☐ Plan tips and final payments for vendors
- ☐ Assign day-of duties to wedding party members
- ☐ Confirm hotel reservations for out-of-town guests
- ☐ Practice first dance if choreographed

Notes: _____

1 MONTH BEFORE

- ☐ Confirm every vendor with final details and timeline
- ☐ Final meeting with venue coordinator
- ☐ Pick up wedding dress from alterations
- ☐ Get marriage license
- ☐ Prepare final payments and tip envelopes
- ☐ Create seating chart cards and table assignments
- ☐ Deliver welcome bags to hotel
- ☐ Finalize vows and have backup copies
- ☐ Confirm rehearsal dinner headcount
- ☐ Pack for honeymoon
- ☐ Arrange for someone to handle gifts at reception
- ☐ Designate someone to return rentals after wedding

Notes: _____

1 WEEK BEFORE

- [] Confirm timeline with all vendors one final time
- [] Rehearsal and rehearsal dinner
- [] Give rings to best man
- [] Prepare emergency kit (stain remover, sewing kit, meds, snacks)
- [] Steam or press wedding attire
- [] Prepare final vendor payments and tips
- [] Charge all devices (phone, camera)
- [] Get mani/pedi
- [] Confirm pickup time for transportation
- [] Relax and enjoy time with loved ones
- [] Early bed the night before - you deserve rest!

Notes: _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 3

- [] Mark your wedding date and count back 12 months
- [] Highlight which month you are currently in
- [] Check off all items already completed
- [] Add any items specific to your cultural or religious needs
- [] Set calendar reminders for upcoming deadlines

CHAPTER 4: VENDOR MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

Choosing the Right Vendors

Your vendors make or break your wedding day experience. The right team of professionals will reduce your stress, execute your vision flawlessly, and handle problems before you even know they exist. Take time to research, compare, and interview multiple options before making decisions.

Key questions to ask every vendor: What is included in your package? What are additional fees? How many events do you handle per day? What is your cancellation and refund policy? Do you have liability insurance? Can I see references from recent clients?

VENDOR COMPARISON: VENUE

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

VENDOR COMPARISON: CATERER

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

VENDOR COMPARISON: PHOTOGRAPHER

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

VENDOR COMPARISON: VIDEOGRAPHER

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

VENDOR COMPARISON: DJ / BAND

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

VENDOR COMPARISON: FLORIST

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

VENDOR COMPARISON: CAKE BAKER

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

VENDOR COMPARISON: HAIR & MAKEUP

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

VENDOR COMPARISON: OFFICIANT

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

VENDOR COMPARISON: TRANSPORTATION

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

VENDOR COMPARISON: RENTAL COMPANY

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

VENDOR COMPARISON: WEDDING PLANNER

OPTION A

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION B

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

OPTION C

Company Name: _____

Contact Person: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Website: _____

Package/Price: \$ _____

What is included: _____

Additional fees: _____

Availability for our date? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Tentative

References checked? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Rating (1-10): ____ Gut feeling (1-10): ____

DECISION: Chosen vendor: _____

Deposit paid: \$ _____ Date: _____ Contract signed? ☐ Yes

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 4

- ☐ Research at least 3 options for each major vendor category
- ☐ Schedule consultations or tastings with top choices
- ☐ Read all contracts carefully before signing
- ☐ Keep copies of all signed contracts in one place
- ☐ Record deposit amounts and remaining payment due dates
- ☐ Ask for vendor recommendations from recently married friends

CHAPTER 5: GUEST MANAGEMENT & TRACKER

Managing Your Guest List

The guest list is often the most emotionally complex part of wedding planning. It affects your budget, venue size, catering costs, and overall atmosphere. Start with your ideal number and work backward, making decisions as a team.

Tips for managing your guest list:

- Set a firm number early and stick to it
- Divide invitations: 50% couple, 25% each family (adjust as needed)
- Create an A-list (must invite) and B-list (invite if space allows)
- Consider plus-one policy early (engaged/married/living together?)
- Kids or no kids? Decide early and communicate clearly

Total capacity of venue: _____

Our target guest count: _____

Estimated RSVPs yes (usually 75-85%): _____

MASTER GUEST TRACKER

| Name | Party Size | Address | RSVP | Meal | Table | Gift | Thank You

1.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
2.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
3.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
4.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
5.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
6.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
7.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
8.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
9.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
10.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
11.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
12.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
13.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
14.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
15.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
16.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
17.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
18.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
19.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
20.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]

21. _____ | ____ | _____ | Y/N | ____ | ____ | [] | []
22. _____ | ____ | _____ | Y/N | ____ | ____ | [] | []
23. _____ | ____ | _____ | Y/N | ____ | ____ | [] | []
24. _____ | ____ | _____ | Y/N | ____ | ____ | [] | []
25. _____ | ____ | _____ | Y/N | ____ | ____ | [] | []

GUEST TRACKER (continued - Rows 26-50)

| Name | Party Size | Address | RSVP | Meal | Table | Gift | Thank You

26.				Y/N				
27.				Y/N				
28.				Y/N				
29.				Y/N				
30.				Y/N				
31.				Y/N				
32.				Y/N				
33.				Y/N				
34.				Y/N				
35.				Y/N				
36.				Y/N				
37.				Y/N				
38.				Y/N				
39.				Y/N				
40.				Y/N				
41.				Y/N				
42.				Y/N				
43.				Y/N				
44.				Y/N				
45.				Y/N				
46.				Y/N				
47.				Y/N				
48.				Y/N				
49.				Y/N				
50.				Y/N				

GUEST TRACKER (continued - Rows 51-75)

| Name | Party Size | Address | RSVP | Meal | Table | Gift | Thank You

51.				Y/N				
52.				Y/N				
53.				Y/N				
54.				Y/N				
55.				Y/N				
56.				Y/N				
57.				Y/N				
58.				Y/N				
59.				Y/N				
60.				Y/N				
61.				Y/N				
62.				Y/N				
63.				Y/N				
64.				Y/N				
65.				Y/N				
66.				Y/N				
67.				Y/N				
68.				Y/N				
69.				Y/N				
70.				Y/N				
71.				Y/N				
72.				Y/N				
73.				Y/N				
74.				Y/N				
75.				Y/N				

GUEST TRACKER (continued - Rows 76-100)

| Name | Party Size | Address | RSVP | Meal | Table | Gift | Thank You

76.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
77.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
78.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
79.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
80.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
81.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
82.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
83.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
84.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
85.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
86.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
87.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
88.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
89.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
90.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
91.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
92.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
93.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
94.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
95.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
96.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
97.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
98.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
99.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]
100.	_____		__		_____		Y/N		__		__		[]		[]

GUEST TRACKER (continued - Rows 101-125)

| Name | Party Size | Address | RSVP | Meal | Table | Gift | Thank You

101.				Y/N				
102.				Y/N				
103.				Y/N				
104.				Y/N				
105.				Y/N				
106.				Y/N				
107.				Y/N				
108.				Y/N				
109.				Y/N				
110.				Y/N				
111.				Y/N				
112.				Y/N				
113.				Y/N				
114.				Y/N				
115.				Y/N				
116.				Y/N				
117.				Y/N				
118.				Y/N				
119.				Y/N				
120.				Y/N				
121.				Y/N				
122.				Y/N				
123.				Y/N				
124.				Y/N				
125.				Y/N				

GUEST TRACKER (continued - Rows 126-150)

| Name | Party Size | Address | RSVP | Meal | Table | Gift | Thank You

126.				Y/N				
127.				Y/N				
128.				Y/N				
129.				Y/N				
130.				Y/N				
131.				Y/N				
132.				Y/N				
133.				Y/N				
134.				Y/N				
135.				Y/N				
136.				Y/N				
137.				Y/N				
138.				Y/N				
139.				Y/N				
140.				Y/N				
141.				Y/N				
142.				Y/N				
143.				Y/N				
144.				Y/N				
145.				Y/N				
146.				Y/N				
147.				Y/N				
148.				Y/N				
149.				Y/N				
150.				Y/N				

GUEST TRACKER (continued - Rows 151-175)

| Name | Party Size | Address | RSVP | Meal | Table | Gift | Thank You

151.				Y/N				
152.				Y/N				
153.				Y/N				
154.				Y/N				
155.				Y/N				
156.				Y/N				
157.				Y/N				
158.				Y/N				
159.				Y/N				
160.				Y/N				
161.				Y/N				
162.				Y/N				
163.				Y/N				
164.				Y/N				
165.				Y/N				
166.				Y/N				
167.				Y/N				
168.				Y/N				
169.				Y/N				
170.				Y/N				
171.				Y/N				
172.				Y/N				
173.				Y/N				
174.				Y/N				
175.				Y/N				

GUEST TRACKER (continued - Rows 176-200)

| Name | Party Size | Address | RSVP | Meal | Table | Gift | Thank You

176.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
177.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
178.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
179.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
180.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
181.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
182.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
183.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
184.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
185.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
186.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
187.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
188.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
189.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
190.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
191.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
192.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
193.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
194.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
195.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
196.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
197.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
198.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
199.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]
200.	_____	__	_____	Y/N	__	__	[]	[]

GUEST LIST SUMMARY

Total invited: _____

RSVPs received: _____

Attending (Yes): _____

Declined (No): _____

No response yet: _____

Total attending (with plus ones): _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 5

-
- [] Complete initial guest list with both families
 - [] Collect mailing addresses for all guests
 - [] Establish plus-one and children policies
 - [] Track RSVPs as they come in

- ☐ Follow up with non-responders 2 weeks after deadline
- ☐ Send final count to caterer

CHAPTER 6: SEATING CHART SYSTEM

Seating Chart Strategy

Creating a seating chart can feel overwhelming, but it ensures your guests have the best possible experience. People who know each other and get along will be seated together, creating natural conversation and comfort.

Tips for successful seating arrangements:

- Start with the head table and VIP tables first
- Group by relationship: college friends, work colleagues, family branches
- Consider conversation compatibility (shared interests, similar ages)
- Separate known conflicts (divorced parents, feuding relatives)
- Place elderly or mobility-limited guests near exits and restrooms
- Put families with young children near the edge for easy exits
- Mix singles together at a fun table (not a sad singles table)

Number of tables needed: _____

Guests per table: _____

Table shape: ☐ Round ☐ Rectangle ☐ Mixed

TABLE 1

Location/Label: _____

Seat 1: _____

Seat 2: _____

Seat 3: _____

Seat 4: _____

Seat 5: _____

Seat 6: _____

Seat 7: _____

Seat 8: _____

Seat 9: _____

Seat 10: _____

Notes: _____

TABLE 2

Location/Label: _____

Seat 1: _____

Seat 2: _____

Seat 3: _____

Seat 4: _____

Seat 5: _____

Seat 6: _____

Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

TABLE 3

Location/Label: _____
Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____
Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

TABLE 4

Location/Label: _____
Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____
Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

TABLE 5

Location/Label: _____
Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____
Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____

Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

TABLE 6

Location/Label: _____
Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____
Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

TABLE 7

Location/Label: _____
Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____
Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

TABLE 8

Location/Label: _____
Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____
Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____

Notes: _____

TABLE 9

Location/Label: _____

Seat 1: _____

Seat 2: _____

Seat 3: _____

Seat 4: _____

Seat 5: _____

Seat 6: _____

Seat 7: _____

Seat 8: _____

Seat 9: _____

Seat 10: _____

Notes: _____

TABLE 10

Location/Label: _____

Seat 1: _____

Seat 2: _____

Seat 3: _____

Seat 4: _____

Seat 5: _____

Seat 6: _____

Seat 7: _____

Seat 8: _____

Seat 9: _____

Seat 10: _____

Notes: _____

TABLE 11

Location/Label: _____

Seat 1: _____

Seat 2: _____

Seat 3: _____

Seat 4: _____

Seat 5: _____

Seat 6: _____

Seat 7: _____

Seat 8: _____

Seat 9: _____

Seat 10: _____

Notes: _____

TABLE 12

Location/Label: _____

Seat 1: _____

Seat 2: _____

Seat 3: _____

Seat 4: _____

Seat 5: _____

Seat 6: _____

Seat 7: _____

Seat 8: _____

Seat 9: _____

Seat 10: _____

Notes: _____

TABLE 13

Location/Label: _____

Seat 1: _____

Seat 2: _____

Seat 3: _____

Seat 4: _____

Seat 5: _____

Seat 6: _____

Seat 7: _____

Seat 8: _____

Seat 9: _____

Seat 10: _____

Notes: _____

TABLE 14

Location/Label: _____

Seat 1: _____

Seat 2: _____

Seat 3: _____

Seat 4: _____

Seat 5: _____

Seat 6: _____

Seat 7: _____

Seat 8: _____

Seat 9: _____

Seat 10: _____

Notes: _____

TABLE 15

Location/Label: _____

Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____
Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

TABLE 16

Location/Label: _____
Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____
Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

TABLE 17

Location/Label: _____
Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____
Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

TABLE 18

Location/Label: _____
Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____

Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

TABLE 19

Location/Label: _____
Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____
Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

TABLE 20

Location/Label: _____
Seat 1: _____
Seat 2: _____
Seat 3: _____
Seat 4: _____
Seat 5: _____
Seat 6: _____
Seat 7: _____
Seat 8: _____
Seat 9: _____
Seat 10: _____
Notes: _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 6

-
- [] Determine table layout with venue coordinator
 - [] Assign head table first (wedding party)
 - [] Group remaining guests by social circles
 - [] Check for conflicts before finalizing

- [] Order place cards and table numbers
- [] Have a backup plan for last-minute RSVPs or cancellations

CHAPTER 7: DAY-OF TIMELINE

Creating Your Perfect Day-Of Schedule

A detailed day-of timeline is the single most important document for ensuring your wedding day runs smoothly. Share this with your wedding party, coordinator, and all vendors so everyone knows exactly where to be and when.

Build in buffer time between activities. Things always take longer than expected on wedding days, and having extra time prevents stress and rushing.

WEDDING DAY TIMELINE

Wedding Date: _____

- 6:00 AM | Wake up, light breakfast, hydrate
Notes: _____
- 6:30 AM | Shower, skincare routine, begin getting ready
Notes: _____
- 7:00 AM | Hair and makeup team arrives at getting-ready location
Notes: _____
- 7:15 AM | First person in hair chair (furthest from bride)
Notes: _____
- 7:30 AM | First person in makeup chair
Notes: _____
- 8:00 AM | Bridesmaids continue hair and makeup rotation
Notes: _____
- 8:30 AM | Light snacks and drinks for getting-ready group
Notes: _____
- 9:00 AM | Bride begins hair
Notes: _____
- 9:30 AM | Groom and groomsmen begin getting dressed
Notes: _____
- 9:45 AM | Bride begins makeup
Notes: _____
- 10:00 AM | Photographer arrives to capture getting-ready details
Notes: _____
- 10:15 AM | Detail shots: dress, shoes, rings, invitations, flowers
Notes: _____
- 10:30 AM | Bride gets into dress (capture the moment)
Notes: _____
- 10:45 AM | Mother/father first look with bride
Notes: _____

11:00 AM | Bridal party first look and group photos
Notes: _____

11:15 AM | First look with partner (if doing one)
Notes: _____

11:30 AM | Couple portraits (golden hour alternative for flexibility)
Notes: _____

11:45 AM | Family formal portraits
Notes: _____

12:00 PM | Full bridal party photos
Notes: _____

12:30 PM | Break - snacks, touch-ups, bathroom break
Notes: _____

1:00 PM | Travel to ceremony venue (if different location)
Notes: _____

1:30 PM | Venue setup check - coordinator confirms all details
Notes: _____

2:00 PM | Musicians/DJ begin setup and sound check
Notes: _____

2:30 PM | Florist delivers and sets up ceremony flowers
Notes: _____

3:00 PM | Ushers arrive and prepare for guest seating
Notes: _____

3:15 PM | Guest shuttle departs from hotel (if applicable)
Notes: _____

3:30 PM | Guests begin arriving - ushers seat them
Notes: _____

3:45 PM | Immediate family seated
Notes: _____

3:55 PM | Groom and groomsmen take positions
Notes: _____

4:00 PM | CEREMONY BEGINS - Processional
Notes: _____

4:05 PM | Bridesmaids walk down aisle
Notes: _____

4:08 PM | Bride walks down aisle
Notes: _____

4:10 PM | Welcome and opening words
Notes: _____

4:15 PM | Readings
Notes: _____

4:20 PM | Vows
Notes: _____

4:25 PM | Ring exchange
Notes: _____

4:30 PM | Pronouncement and first kiss
Notes: _____

4:32 PM | Recessional - newlyweds exit
Notes: _____

4:35 PM | Receiving line or post-ceremony photos
Notes: _____

4:45 PM | Guests transition to cocktail hour
Notes: _____

5:00 PM | COCKTAIL HOUR BEGINS
Notes: _____

5:00 PM | Couple takes additional portraits during golden hour
Notes: _____

5:30 PM | Couple joins cocktail hour briefly
Notes: _____

5:45 PM | Guests invited to move to reception area
Notes: _____

6:00 PM | RECEPTION BEGINS - Guests seated
Notes: _____

6:05 PM | Wedding party introduced
Notes: _____

6:10 PM | Couple grand entrance
Notes: _____

6:15 PM | First dance
Notes: _____

6:20 PM | Welcome speech and blessing/grace
Notes: _____

6:30 PM | Dinner service begins (first course)
Notes: _____

7:00 PM | Main course served
Notes: _____

7:15 PM | Toasts and speeches (best man, maid of honor, parents)
Notes: _____

7:45 PM | Parent dances (father-daughter, mother-son)
Notes: _____

8:00 PM | Cake cutting
Notes: _____

8:15 PM | Open dancing begins
Notes: _____

8:30 PM | Bouquet and garter toss (if desired)
Notes: _____

9:00 PM | Special dances (anniversary dance, etc.)
Notes: _____

9:30 PM | Late-night snack station opens
Notes: _____

10:00 PM | Last dance announced
Notes: _____

10:15 PM | Grand exit (sparklers, bubbles, confetti)
Notes: _____

10:30 PM | Couple departs

Notes: _____

10:30 PM | Coordinator oversees venue cleanup and rental returns

Notes: _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 7

-
- ☐ Customize this timeline with your specific times
 - ☐ Share final timeline with ALL vendors at least 2 weeks before
 - ☐ Give a printed copy to your coordinator and wedding party
 - ☐ Build in 15-minute buffers between major transitions
 - ☐ Assign someone to keep the day on schedule

CHAPTER 8: DESIGN & DECOR PLANNER

Defining Your Wedding Aesthetic

Your wedding decor tells the story of who you are as a couple. Whether you prefer minimalist elegance, rustic charm, modern sophistication, or bohemian whimsy, consistency across all visual elements creates a cohesive and memorable experience for your guests.

Color Palette

Primary Color: _____

Secondary Color: _____

Accent Color: _____

Neutral Base: _____

Style Keywords (circle 3-5)

Romantic | Modern | Rustic | Vintage | Bohemian | Classic | Glamorous

Minimalist | Industrial | Garden | Beach | Whimsical | Elegant | Moody

Decor Element Tracker

Ceremony Space

☐ Arch or backdrop: _____

☐ Aisle runner: _____

☐ Aisle decorations (petals, lanterns): _____

☐ Pew/chair markers: _____

☐ Welcome sign: _____

☐ Programs display: _____

☐ Unity ceremony items: _____

Cocktail Hour

☐ Lounge furniture: _____

☐ Bar signage: _____

☐ Cocktail napkins: _____

☐ Guest book station: _____

☐ Photo display: _____

☐ Escort card display: _____

Reception Tables

☐ Centerpieces: _____

☐ Table runners or linens: _____

☐ Place settings: _____

☐ Napkin style and fold: _____

- ☐ Menu cards: _____
- ☐ Table numbers: _____
- ☐ Candles/votives: _____
- ☐ Charger plates: _____
- ☐ Glassware style: _____

Head Table

- ☐ Sweetheart table or long table?: _____
- ☐ Backdrop or greenery wall: _____
- ☐ Special centerpiece: _____
- ☐ Mr and Mrs sign: _____
- ☐ Special chairs: _____

Dance Floor & Stage

- ☐ Dance floor decal or monogram: _____
- ☐ Uplighting color: _____
- ☐ String lights: _____
- ☐ Disco ball or special effects: _____
- ☐ Backdrop for band/DJ: _____

Cake & Dessert

- ☐ Cake table and display: _____
- ☐ Dessert table setup: _____
- ☐ Cake topper: _____
- ☐ Serving set: _____
- ☐ Signage for desserts: _____

Photo Areas

- ☐ Photo booth backdrop: _____
- ☐ Props: _____
- ☐ Guest book alternative: _____
- ☐ Polaroid station: _____
- ☐ Hashtag sign: _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 8

-
- ☐ Finalize color palette with swatches
 - ☐ Create mood board with inspiration images
 - ☐ List all decor items needed and their sources
 - ☐ Get quotes for rental items vs purchased items
 - ☐ Assign decor setup tasks for day-of
 - ☐ Plan what happens to decor after wedding (keep, donate, sell)

CHAPTER 9: HONEYMOON PLANNER

Planning Your Perfect Getaway

Your honeymoon is the well-deserved celebration after months of wedding planning. Whether it is a tropical beach escape, a European adventure, a cozy mountain retreat, or a multi-destination journey, planning it alongside your wedding ensures you have something wonderful to look forward to.

Honeymoon Basics

Destination: _____

Departure date: _____ Return date: _____

Duration: _____ days

Budget: \$ _____

Travel Documents Checklist

- ☐ Passports valid (6+ months from travel date)
- ☐ Visas required? _____ Applied for? ☐ Yes
- ☐ Travel insurance purchased? ☐ Yes
- ☐ Copies of all documents (physical and digital)
- ☐ Name change needed before travel? Timeline: _____
- ☐ Vaccinations or medications needed?
- ☐ International phone plan activated
- ☐ Bank notified of international travel

Bookings & Reservations

Flights: _____ Confirmation #: _____

Hotel/Resort: _____ Confirmation #: _____

Car Rental: _____ Confirmation #: _____

Activity 1: _____ Confirmation #: _____

Activity 2: _____ Confirmation #: _____

Activity 3: _____ Confirmation #: _____

Restaurant 1: _____ Reservation time: _____

Restaurant 2: _____ Reservation time: _____

Packing Checklist

- ☐ Passports and IDs
- ☐ Printed confirmations and itinerary
- ☐ Medications and first aid
- ☐ Phone chargers and adapters
- ☐ Sunscreen and toiletries
- ☐ Comfortable walking shoes
- ☐ Swimwear

- ☐ Dressy outfits for dinners
- ☐ Camera and memory cards
- ☐ Travel pillow and eye mask
- ☐ Books or entertainment for flights
- ☐ Snacks for travel days

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 9

- ☐ Choose destination and discuss preferences together
- ☐ Set honeymoon budget
- ☐ Book flights and accommodations (6+ months out for best prices)
- ☐ Research activities and make reservations
- ☐ Verify travel documents are current
- ☐ Purchase travel insurance

CHAPTER 10: POST-WEDDING TASKS

After the Big Day

The wedding is over but there are still important tasks to handle. This chapter helps you tie up loose ends, preserve memories, and start your married life organized and stress-free.

Week 1 After Wedding

- ☐ Send vendor tips if not distributed day-of
- ☐ Return any rented items (tuxes, decor, equipment)
- ☐ Preserve wedding dress (dry clean and store properly)
- ☐ Change social media status if desired
- ☐ Begin writing thank you notes (aim for 10 per day)
- ☐ Organize and store wedding cards and gifts

Week 2-4 After Wedding

- ☐ Complete all thank you notes (send within 3 months)
- ☐ Begin name change process if applicable
- ☐ Update identification documents
- ☐ Update bank accounts and credit cards
- ☐ Update insurance policies
- ☐ Review and rate vendors online (they appreciate reviews)
- ☐ Organize wedding photos when received
- ☐ Order prints or albums

Name Change Checklist (if applicable)

- ☐ Social Security card
- ☐ Drivers license or state ID
- ☐ Passport
- ☐ Bank accounts
- ☐ Credit cards
- ☐ Insurance policies (health, auto, home)
- ☐ Employer/HR records
- ☐ Voter registration
- ☐ Utilities and subscriptions
- ☐ Professional licenses
- ☐ Email signature and business cards

Thank You Note Tracker

Use this to track who you have thanked:

1. Name: _____ Gift: _____ Sent: ☐

2. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
3. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
4. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
5. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
6. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
7. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
8. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
9. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
10. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
11. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
12. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
13. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
14. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
15. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
16. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
17. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
18. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
19. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
20. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
21. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
22. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
23. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
24. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
25. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
26. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
27. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
28. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
29. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐
30. Name: _____	Gift: _____	Sent: ☐

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 10

-
- ☐ Create thank you note schedule (10 per day)
 - ☐ Return all rentals within the specified timeframe
 - ☐ Start name change process within 30 days
 - ☐ Back up all wedding photos to cloud storage
 - ☐ Leave reviews for your amazing vendors

NEXT STEPS

Congratulations! Whether you are just starting your planning journey or deep in the details, this planner is your comprehensive companion. Remember: the wedding is ONE day, but the marriage is forever. Do not let planning stress overshadow the joy of this season.

Final Reminders:

- Communicate openly with your partner throughout planning
- Delegate tasks - you do not have to do everything yourself
- Build in contingency budget (5-10%) for surprises
- Take breaks from wedding planning regularly
- Remember why you are doing this - you are marrying your person!

By Daniel Tesfamariam

Wishing you a beautiful wedding and an even more beautiful marriage.